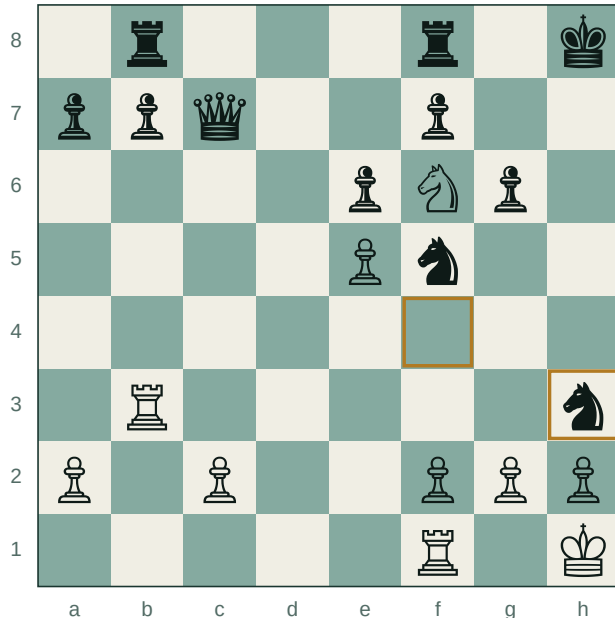


Hook mating nets: White, move 25

Hook mating nets

White to move



Previous move: 24...Nxh3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. Rxh3+ Nh4 26. Rxh4+ Kg7 27. Rh7#

25.Rxh3+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on h3. Recorded reply: **25...Nh4**.

26.Rxh4+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the knight on h4. Recorded reply: **26...Kg7**.

27.Rh7# Mate: rook on h7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Recount the king's legal replies after each move. A changed pawn placement can destroy an otherwise familiar mating pattern.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A hook-type mating net combines rook pressure with knight control and supporting pawn geometry. The supporting pieces can matter more than the apparent value of a sacrifice.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the final checking line and then trace which friendly pieces protect the attacker and control the king's exits.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: queen on c7 and knight on h3. Check for tactical protection.